

# Saturday, 26 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

## Tomorrow's forecast

|                               |                                   |                                   |                               |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------|-----------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| LONDON<br>Overcast<br>20° 14° | BIRMINGHAM<br>Overcast<br>19° 10° | MANCHESTER<br>Overcast<br>18° 10° | GLASGOW<br>Drizzle<br>17° 12° |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------|-----------------------------------|-------------------------------|

01 — NEWS

## Today's top stories

- 1

**The NHS is set to suspend staff who are suspected of illegally snooping on patient records, after too many cases of abuse of trust.**

The head of NHS England says enough is enough, and they'll be taking a tougher stance. It follows numerous incidents where staff have accessed confidential information without permission.

HEALTH · UK
- 2

**The Prime Minister has called for an urgent review into the case of a bailed sex offender who was living close to his victims.**

Zafer Dogan, 32, took thousands of pictures of children from his bedroom window near a playground. His victims were living nearby, sparking serious concerns.

CRIME · UK
- 3

**The victim of former DUP leader Jeffrey Donaldson has spoken out about the "profound impact" of child sex abuse.**

Donaldson was found guilty of 18 counts of child sex abuse, including one of rape, back in June. This powerful testimony highlights the long-lasting effects on survivors.

CRIME · UK
- 4

**Glasgow City Council has paused its controversial plan to fire and rehire 23,000 staff members.**

Talks between the council and three unions are set to resume early next week. They're hoping to reach a new deal on pay after widespread opposition to the proposals.

WORK · UK
- 5

**The Foreign Secretary has told Iran's minister that the UK will not tolerate "hostile activity" on British soil.**

He stressed the UK's unwavering resolve to combat threats from Iranian-linked groups. This includes protecting the British Jewish community from potential attacks.

POLITICS · UK

## What's coming up

### 1 **The Turner Prize gallery has been hailed as the "centre of the creative universe" as this year's exhibition opens.**

Work by the four nominated artists will go on display from today. It's always a big talking point in the art world, sparking debate and discussion.

**ON AIR** – Have you ever visited the Turner Prize exhibition? What do you make of the nominated works?

ART · THIS WEEK

### 2 **Catherine Zeta-Jones is basing her new role on the funny Welsh people she knows, for her upcoming film 'Kill Jackie'.**

She plays Jackie Price, a former cocaine dealer targeted by assassins. It sounds like a thrilling and entertaining new project for the Welsh star.

**ON AIR** – Who is your favourite Welsh actor or actress on screen right now?

FILM · COMING SOON

### 3 **Rapper Macklemore has announced a 'Free Palestine' tour, with proceeds going to organisations supporting Palestinians.**

The tour is set to kick off in Dublin next month. It follows a recent fallout involving Ed Sheeran, adding to the conversation around artists and their causes.

**ON AIR** – Do you think it's important for artists to use their platform to support political or social causes?

MUSIC · NEXT MONTH

### 4 **Great news for fans of 'The Inbetweeners' – Netflix has confirmed a new film is on the way, with the original stars returning!**

The much-loved coming-of-age sitcom is getting a big-screen revival. It's sure to bring back plenty of laughs and nostalgia for viewers.

**ON AIR** – Which 'Inbetweeners' character was your favourite, and why?

FILM · COMING SOON

### 5 **The judges for this year's Booker Prize have revealed their shortlisted novels, after what they described as a selection "tussle".**

Past Booker winners Marlon James and Douglas Stuart are among the nominees for this prestigious literary award. It's always a hotly anticipated moment in the literary calendar.

**ON AIR** – Have you read any of the shortlisted Booker Prize novels, or do you have a favourite author you hope wins?

BOOKS · COMING SOON

## On the schedule

### 1 **After more than two years, a judgement finally appears to have been made on the 115 charges levelled against Manchester City.**

This is huge news for the Premier League champions, and the football world is waiting to hear the outcome. It's been a long-running saga, but we could be getting answers soon.

**ON AIR** – What do you think the potential sanctions for Manchester City should be, if they're found guilty?  
FOOTBALL · UK

### 2 **George Russell has taken pole position for Mercedes at the Azerbaijan Grand Prix, with team-mate Kimi Antonelli crashing out.**

It's a fantastic result for Russell, but a frustrating one for championship leader Antonelli, who will now start from 16th on the grid. This sets up a really interesting race tomorrow.

**ON AIR** – Who are you backing to win the Azerbaijan Grand Prix after that dramatic qualifying session?  
F1 · THIS WEEK

### 3 **Sri Lanka have beaten England in a surprise victory at Headingley, setting up a series decider at The Oval on Sunday.**

Kusal Mendis scored a brilliant 121 to help Sri Lanka level the three-match series. It means everything comes down to the final game this weekend.

**ON AIR** – Who do you think will come out on top in the cricket series decider between England and Sri Lanka?  
CRICKET · UK

### 4 **Wales will be looking to prove they are no "one-hit wonder" as they face USA at Cardiff Arms Park on Saturday.**

Both teams had impressive opening round victories in the WXV, so this promises to be a great match. It's a chance for Wales to build on their momentum.

**ON AIR** – Are you following the WXV rugby, and who are you supporting in the Wales vs USA match?  
RUGBY · UK

### 5 **New Scotland head coach Sebastien Pocognoli faces a big decision on his line-up for Saturday's match in Slovenia.**

Former Scotland forwards are trying to guess who Pocognoli will pick for his new-look squad. It's an exciting time for Scottish football under new leadership.

**ON AIR** – If you were the new Scotland coach, what changes would you make to the team for tomorrow's game?  
FOOTBALL · UK

## Quick hits

- 1 A new trend sees city dwellers 'reclaiming' small urban spaces to create tiny, vibrant wildlife havens.**  
From planting wildflowers in window boxes to installing mini bug hotels on balconies, people are finding creative ways to boost biodiversity right on their doorsteps.
- 2 Scientists are exploring the fascinating world of 'plant communication' and how flora might 'talk' to each other.**  
Research suggests that trees and plants can send signals through underground fungal networks, sharing nutrients and even warning each other of pests.
- 3 The charming practice of 'library scavenger hunts' is growing, encouraging families to explore local libraries in a playful new way.**  
Participants follow clues hidden among the bookshelves, often leading to discovering new genres or authors they might not have otherwise picked up.
- 4 More people are discovering the calming craft of 'sea glass collecting', turning coastal walks into treasure hunts.**  
The smooth, frosted pieces of glass, tumbled by the ocean, are being used for jewellery making or simply displayed as natural art.
- 5 The simple joy of 'writing and sending postcards' is making a nostalgic comeback in our digital age.**  
People are finding delight in sending handwritten messages and unique local scenes to friends and family, offering a tangible connection in a fast-paced world.
- 6 A recent study suggests that 'listening to classical music' while doing chores can make tasks feel less mundane.**  
Participants reported increased focus and a more positive mood, turning everyday tidying into a more enjoyable experience.
- 7 The delightful hobby of 'miniature gardening' is captivating enthusiasts, creating tiny landscapes in pots and terrariums.**  
These intricate scenes often feature tiny plants, pathways, and even miniature furniture, bringing a touch of whimsical magic indoors.

05 – TALKBACK

## For the phone lines

### OUR SURVEY SAID

**Q** Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new bar of chocolate, especially if it's a fancy one. What is it?

**ANSWER:** BREAKING IT INTO PERFECT SQUARES ALONG THE LINES, EVEN IF IT CRUMBLES A LITTLE.

**Q** Our survey said that over 75% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of crisps will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?

**ANSWER:** SMELLING THEM BEFORE OPENING THE PACKET FULLY TO GET A HINT OF THE FLAVOUR.

### TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a 'particular type of street art' or a well-placed mural can just instantly brighten your day as you walk past it?

Have you ever stumbled upon a piece of public art that really resonated with you, and what was it?

- We all have that 'one small, everyday act of self-care' that, no matter how busy things get, you always try to make time for because it genuinely makes you feel better, don't we?

What's that one little ritual or moment of calm you carve out for yourself each day or week?

### TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

**FACT** **Animals.** Did you know that a group of owls is actually called a 'parliament'?

**FICTION** **Made up, but believable.** It's said that in ancient times, Roman engineers used a special type of volcanic ash in their concrete that allowed structures to self-repair minor cracks over centuries.

06 – LOTTERY

## Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

**£5.8 million**

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

**£5.8 million**

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

## Did you know?

- The world's oldest known living tree, Methuselah, is a bristlecone pine in California, estimated to be over 4,850 years old.
- Butterflies taste with their feet, using chemoreceptors to find host plants and nectar.
- The Great Barrier Reef is the largest living structure on Earth, visible even from outer space.
- A 'bibliosmia' is the delightful habit of smelling old books.
- The sound of a human sneeze can travel at speeds of up to 100 miles per hour.
- There are more possible iterations of a game of chess than there are atoms in the observable universe.
- Flamingos are not born pink; their famous colour comes from beta-carotene in their diet of brine shrimp and algae.
- The shortest complete English sentence is 'I am.'

## On this day

Day 269 of the year, 96 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast days: Canadian Martyrs (Catholic Church in Canada); Christian feast days: Cosmas and Damian; Christian feast days: Blessed Crescencia Valls Espí; Christian feast days: John of Meda. Star sign Libra, birthstone Sapphire.

### TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1975 — Jake Paltrow, American director and screenwriter
- 1989 — Jonny Bairstow, English cricketer
- 1973 — Julianne Davis, American actress, producer, and screenwriter
- 1962 — Tracey Thorn, English singer-songwriter and writer
- 1973 — Chris Small, Scottish snooker player and coach
- 1969 — Paul Warhurst, English footballer and manager
- 1968 — Jim Caviezel, American actor
- 1956 — Linda Hamilton, American actress

### THE DAY TODAY

- 2002 — The overcrowded Senegalese ferry, MV Le Joola, capsizes off the coast of the Gambia killing more than 1,000.
- 1933 — As gangster Machine Gun Kelly surrenders to the FBI, he shouts out, "Don't shoot, G-Men!", which becomes a nickname for FBI agents.
- 2014 — A mass kidnapping of 43 students from a teaching college occurs in Iguala, Mexico.

### TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2009 — Typhoon Ketsana hits the Philippines, China, Vietnam, Cambodia, Laos and Thailand, causing 700 fatalities.
- 1994 — A Yakovlev Yak-40 crashes into a river near Vanavara, Russia, killing 24.

### TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1978 — Air Caribbean Flight 309 crashes in Residencial Las Casas in San Juan, Puerto Rico, killing six.
- 1992 — A Nigerian Air Force Lockheed C-130 Hercules crashes in Ejigbo, Lagos, killing 159.

- 1923 — The German government calls off the passive resistance to the French and Belgian occupation of the Ruhr.

## A peek at tomorrow

Day 270 of the year, 95 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast days: Adheritus; Christian feast days: Bonfilius; Christian feast days: Caius of Milan; Christian feast days: Hiltrude of Liessies. Star sign Libra, birthstone Sapphire.

### TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1956 — Martin Handford, English children's author and illustrator
- 1972 — Gwyneth Paltrow, American actress, blogger, and businesswoman
- 1991 — Thomas Mann, American actor
- 1948 — Les Chapman, English footballer and manager
- 1973 — Indira Varma, British actress
- 1963 — Marc Maron, American comedian, actor, and radio host
- 1978 — Brad Arnold, American singer-songwriter (died 2026)
- 1942 — Alvin Stardust, English singer and actor (died 2014)

### THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2007 — NASA launches the Dawn probe to the asteroid belt.
- 1964 — The British TSR-2 aircraft XR219 makes its maiden flight.
- 1988 — The National League for Democracy is formed by Aung San Suu Kyi and others to fight dictatorship in Myanmar.

### TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1949 — Zeng Liansong's design is chosen as the flag of the People's Republic of China.
- 2003 — The SMART-1 satellite is launched.

# Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16                      Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23                      Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

## On the sporting calendar